Jheelum Sarkar

Ph.D. Student · Economics
American University, Washington, DC, USA
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Education

Ph.D. in Economics — *Washington, DC, USA*
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY — *Aug. 2022 - May 2027*
- Fields: Applied Microeconomics (Labor and Development)
- Advisor: Prof. Kara Reynolds, Prof. Mary Hansen & Dr. Austin Davis

M.A. in Economics — *Washington, DC, USA*
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY — *Aug. 2022 - Aug. 2024*

M.Phil. in International Trade and Development — *New Delhi, India*
JAWAHARLAL NEHRU UNIVERSITY (JNU) — *Aug. 2020 - Jun. 2022*
- Thesis: *Welfare Effects of Extreme Climate Events on Mountain and Coastal Communities in India: A Case Study*
- Advisor: Prof. Meeta K. Mehra

M.A. in Economics with Specialization in World Economy — *New Delhi, India*
JAWAHARLAL NEHRU UNIVERSITY (JNU) — *Aug. 2018 - Jul. 2020*
- Project: *Short Run Impact of Climate Change on Agriculture in India*
- Advisor: Prof. Sangeeta Bansal

B.Sc. (Hons.) in Economics — *Kolkata, India*
LADY BRABOURNE COLLEGE, UNIVERSITY OF CALCUTTA — *Jul. 2015 - Jun. 2018*
- Thesis: *Structure of Employment in India*

Working Papers

- Sarkar J. (2025). Can Telework be Anti-Dote to Declining U.S. Fertility Rates? *Manuscript in Preparation.*
- Sarkar J. (2025). Droughts and Deluges: Droughts and Deluges: Effects of Climate Extremes on the Gender Gap in Labor Supply. arxiv: 2602.07808
- Sarkar, J. (2025). Who gets hit first and who recovers last? Evidence from Indian Coastal Flood Shock. SSRN: 5577351
- Sarkar J. (2024). Linking Climate Change with Economic Inequality: A Review Essay. SSRN: 4814257

Work in Progress

- Does Telework Exposure increase Female Labor Supply in Emerging Economies? Evidence from Indian Labor Market
- Cash Transfer Programs, Marital Age and Intimate Partner Violence: Evidence from India (with Prof. Devika Hazra and Dr. Nayantara Biswas).
- Can Affordable Internet Reduce Intimate Partner Violence?
- Environmental Justice and Enforcement of Pollution Standards in United States (with Dr. Phuong Ho, Dr. Bianca Cecato and Dr. Almira Salimgarieva).
- Environmental Degradation and Women's Time Poverty in Rural India.

Publication

Sultana, N., **Sarkar, J.**, & Meurs, M. (2024). Climate Change-Induced Migration: A Gendered Conceptual Framework. *Migration and Diversity, 3*(2), 215-233. https://doi.org/10.33182/md.v3i2.3177

Guest Blogs & Commentaries

- Beyond the Plough: How Technology is Powering a New Green Revolution (with Rida Hameed)— Kogod Sustainability Review, January 20, 2025
- Rethinking climate migration through a gender lens (with Prof. Meurs)— Program for Gender Analysis in Economics Blog, July 19, 2025.
- Time poverty and climate shocks: how married women bear the brunt — Revaluing Care Economy, October 21, 2024

Research Experience

Summer Research Assistant — *Applied Economics Clinic, Remote*
ADVISOR: DR. ELIZABETH STATON — *May 2025 — Aug 2025*
- Conduct Literature Reviews, Assist in Survey Preparations, Writing Policy Memos
- Collect Data, Manage Research Database, Run Data Analysis

Floods and Labor Market through Gender Lens: A Case from India
American University, DC, USA

ADVISOR: DR. KELLY M. JONES — *Aug 2025 — May 2025*

- Develop Flood Exposure Measure using information from Google Earth Engine and Census Data
- Utilize Difference-in-Difference Strategy to estimate causal relationship between flood and labor market outcomes by gender.

Government Housing and Entrepreneurship in Indian Slums
American University, Washington, DC, USA

WITH DR. GARIMA SHARMA — *May 2024 — Aug 2024*

- Analyzed qualitative data using ATLAS.ti from primary surveys of slum dwellers in Orissa, India.
- Demonstrated relationship between dignity of dwelling and social entrepreneurship.

Pew Research Center Dataset Analysis on Religion and Cultural Trends
American University, Washington, DC, USA

WITH PROF. BORIS GERSHMAN — *June 2024 — July 2024*

- Extracted and cleaned a multi-country, multi-wave dataset on religious pluralism in South and Southeast Asia.
- Studied inter-temporal trends in cultural beliefs, attitudes, and values, including variations by religion, educational attainment, socioeconomic background, and gender.

Transformations and Resilience of Pastoral Systems Amidst Rapid Social-Environmental Changes in Mongolia
American University, Washington, DC, USA

WITH PROF. MIEKE MEURS — *June 2023 — Aug 2023*

- Developed a theoretical framework to study the intersection of climate change, migration and household decision-making through gender lens.
- Performed systematic literature reviews on climate change, migration, bargaining power and household dynamics with special focus on Mongolia.

Mapping Climate Risk Index: A Case Study of Ladakh, India (Knowledge for Climate Project)
JNU, New Delhi, India

WITH PROF. MEETA K. MEHRA
(In collaboration with University of Zurich, University of Bern, and ETH Zurich, Switzerland) — *June 2020 -July 2021*

- Developed a quantitative Climate Risk Index for sub-districts in Ladakh, India, using Principal Component Analysis.
- Performed inter-temporal analyses and simulations using detailed demographic, socioeconomic, and physical data at the sub-district level.

COVID-19 and Green Recovery in South Asia: Opportunities for Recovering Better
JNU, New Delhi, India

WITH PROF. MEETA K. MEHRA
(Commissioned by Council for Strategic and Defense Research) — *Dec 2020 -Feb 2021*

- Developed policy menus for sustainable recovery from the pandemic.
- Focused on the enormous green potential within South Asian countries such as green transport systems, climate-friendly infrastructure, green manufacturing, decarbonizing transitions.

Professional Experience

Managing Editor, Kogod Sustainability Review
American University, Washington, DC, USA

WITH KOGOD BUSINESS SCHOOL — *May 2025 — Present*

- Develop strategies to elevate KSR's outreach and highlight contributions from professional experts in sustainability
- Collaborate with editors to ensure quality check of articles

Editor, Kogod Sustainability Review
American University, Washington, DC, USA

WITH KOGOD BUSINESS SCHOOL — *May 2024 — May 2025*

- Edited and reviewed articles, working closely with authors and the editorial board to ensure accuracy, clarity, and adherence to guidelines.
- Developed compelling content on sustainability and business practices.

Teaching Experience

ECON 807: Microeconomics II
American University, Washington, DC, USA

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF PROF. MIEKE MEURS — *Fall 2026*

- Conduct one-to-one office hours, graded assignments and exams

ECON 316: Political Economy of Race in U.S.
American University, Washington, DC, USA

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF PROF. MIEKE MEURS — *Fall 2026*

- Conduct one-to-one office hours, graded assignments and exams

ECON 100: Macroeconomics
American University, Washington, DC, USA

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF PROF. JON D WISMAN and DR. BERNHARD GUNTER — *Fall 2025, 2022*

- Conduct lectures during discussion sessions, graded assignments and exams (class size above 100)

ECON 623: Applied Econometrics I
American University, Washington, DC, USA

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF DR. NATALIA RADCHENKO — *Spring 2025*

- Taught students one-on-one in office hours, conduct in-class lectures and graded exams

ECON 322: Applied Econometrics I
American University, Washington, DC, USA

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF DR. PAUL SULLIVAN — *Spring 2025*

- Taught students one-on-one in office hours, graded assignments and exams

ECON 373: Labor Economics — *American University, Washington, DC, USA*

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF DR. PAUL SULLIVAN — *Spring 2025*

- Taught students one-on-one in office hours, graded assignments and exams

ECON 824: Advanced Econometrics — *American University, Washington, DC, USA*

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF DR. AMOS GOLAN — *Fall 2024*

- Taught students one-on-one in office hours and graded exams

ECON 150: Economics for Business — *American University, Washington, DC, USA*

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF DR. MARY E. HANSEN — *Spring 2024*

- Taught students one-on-one in office hours and graded exams

ECON 803: Microeconomic Analysis — *American University, Washington, DC, USA*

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF DR. SUNH AH BAHK — *Fall 2023*

- Taught students one-on-one in office hours and graded exams

ECON 300: Intermediate Microeconomics — *American University, Washington, DC, USA*

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF DR. SUNH AH BAHK — *Fall 2023*

- Taught students one-on-one in office hours and graded exams

ECON 200: Microeconomics — *American University, Washington, DC, USA*

TEACHING ASSISTANT OF DR. DANIEL LIN — *Spring 2022*

- Graded exams and maintaining log files

Invited Talks

Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur — *Kanpur, Uttar Pradesh, India* — *January 2026*

Indian Institute of Technology, Madras — *Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India* — *January 2026*

Azim Premji University — *Bangalore, Andhra Pradesh, India* — *January 2026*

National Institute of Advanced Studies — *Bangalore, Andhra Pradesh, India* — *December 2025*

Centre for Studies in Social Sciences — *Kolkata, West Bengal, India* — *December 2025*

Conferences, Talks & Workshops

Fourth Global Carework Summit — *Duke University, Durham, NC, USA* — *June 2025*

Eastern Economic Association 2025 — *New York City, NY, USA* — *February 2025*

Revaluing Care in the Global Economy Workshop — *Duke University (Online)* — *September 2024*

Levy Institute Gender Workshop — *Levy Institute, NY, USA* — *September 2024*

Eastern Economic Association 2024 — *Boston, MA, USA* — *March 2024*

International Society for Ecological Economics — *Online*
European Ecological Economics, and Degrowth — *July 2021*

Awards & Scholarships

- **Honorarium for Revaluing Care Working Paper Series** — *Duke University, Durham, NC, USA* — *October/November 2024*
  WITH REVALUING CARE NETWORK
- **4th Barbara Bergmann Graduate Fellowship for Gender Research** — *American University, Washington, DC, USA* — *May 2024 — Aug 2024*
  WITH DEPT. OF ECONOMICS
- **Graduate Merit Fellowship** — *American University, Washington, DC, USA* — *Aug 2022 — Present*
  WITH DEPT. OF ECONOMICS
- **Third Prize for Best Performance in the B.Sc. Economics program** — *Lady Brabourne College, Kolkata, India* — *Dec. 2018*
  WITH DEPT. OF ECONOMICS

Skills

Programming	R, Stata, Python
Tools	ArcGIS, QGIS, Google Earth Engine
Typesetting	LaTeX
Languages	English (fluent), Bengali (native), Hindi (fluent)

References

Prof. Kara Reynolds (Main Advisor)
Dept. of Economics
American University
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Washington, DC 20016, USA
Email Address – reynolds@american.edu

Prof. Mary E. Hansen
Dept. of Economics
American University
4400 Massachusetts Ave NW
Washington, DC 20016, USA
Email Address – mhansen@american.edu

Prof. Austin Davis
Department of Politics, Governance & Economics
American University,
4400 Massachusetts Ave NW
Washington, DC 20016, USA
Email Address – cadavis@american.edu